

0.0.1 Janavasabha (excerpt)

janavasabhasuttam (excerpt)

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Natika at the brick hall. At that time, at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

evam me sutam: ekam samayam bhagavaṃ nātike¹
viharati giṇṇakāvasathe. tena kho pana samayena
bhagavaṃ parito parito janapadesu paricārake ab-

bhatīte kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti, kāsikosa-
 lesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu² kurupañcālesu mac-
 chasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra
 upapanno ti. paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā
 abbhatītā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ
 saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha pari-
 nibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā
 navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-
 ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgadosamohānaṃ
 tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva³ imaṃ lokam āgan-
 tvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañca-
 satāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā, tiṇ-
 ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avini-
 pātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti.

2. The [Natika people] heard of the Natika disciples:
 Apparently at each and every place within the country,
 the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who
 had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the
 Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the
 Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the
 Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.”
 “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and
 passed away, from the complete extinction of the five
 fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born
 spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that
 place, not subject to return from that world. More than
 ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed
 away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters

and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

assosum kho nātikiyā paricārakā: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhātite kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrase-
nesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno’ti.
paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgadosamohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā”ti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesum pamuditā pītisomanas-sajātā bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇaṃ⁴ sutvā.

3. The venerable Ananda heard: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

assosi kho āyasmā ānando: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti. kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno ti. paro-

paññāsanātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā pañcannam orambhāgiyānam saññojanānam parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇam saññojanānam parikkhayā rāgadosamohānam tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti, sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇam saññojanānam parikkhayā sotāpunnā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesum pamuditā pītisomanassajāta bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇam sutvā”ti.

4. Then this occurred to the venerable Ananda: “But there were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: ime kho panāpi¹ ahesum māgadhakā paricārakā bahū ceva

rattaññū ca abbhātītā kālakatā. suññā maññe aṅ-
gamagadhā aṅgamāgadhakehi² paricārahehi ab-
bhatītehi kālakatehi. te kho paṇāpi ahesuṃ bud-
dhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā
sīlesu paripūrakārino te abbhātītā kālakatā bha-
gavatā abyākatā. tesampassa³ sādhu veyyākara-
ṇaṃ. bahujaṇo pasīdeyya tato gaccheyya suga-
tiṃ.

5. Also this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king’s kindom.” Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn’t the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away, that would be

a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

ayaṃ kho paṇāpi ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhammarājā hito brāhmaṇagahapatikānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissudaṃ manussā kittayamānarūpā viharanti 'evaṃ no so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayaṃ tassa dhammikassa dhammarāṇṇo vijite phāsu⁴ viharimhā'ti. so kho paṇāpi ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudaṃ manussā evamāhaṃsu 'yāva maraṇakālāpi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro bhagavantam kittayamānarūpo kālakato'ti. so abbhatīto kālakato bhagavatā abyākato. tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahujaṇo pasīdeyya, tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ. bhagavato kho pana sambodhi magadhesu. yattha kho bhagavato sambodhi magadhesu, kathaṃ tattha bhagavā māgadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byākareyya? bhagavā ceva kho pana māgadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byākareyya dīnamanā tenassu māgadhakā paricārakā. yena kho panassu dīnamanā māgadhakā paricārakā kathaṃ te bhagavā na byākareyyāti.

